

Question 13 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse how a weak HRD climate can affect employee behaviour and organisational performance.

Introduction

To analyse means to show a chain: cause → how people start behaving → what happens to results. A weak HRD climate is a workplace atmosphere in which employees do not feel trust, openness, support for learning, fairness of opportunity, or collaboration. Leaders may still print ‘people are our greatest asset’, but daily experience is fear, silence, favouritism or neglect.

Climate is not a soft decoration. Behaviour follows climate. Organisational performance — quality, quantity, cost, customer service, innovation, survival — is produced by that behaviour. So a weak HRD climate is a performance problem, not only a ‘morale’ complaint.

Detailed points

- 1. Fear, silence and hiding of mistakes.** When people expect humiliation or punishment, they hide errors and stop asking doubts. A machine operator who made a small mistake will not report it; the defect reaches the customer. A nurse who is unsure of a dose will not ask, and a patient may be harmed. Behaviour becomes self-protective. Organisational performance then suffers through late discovery of problems, accidents and complaints. The organisation thinks everything is fine until a crisis.
- 2. Low initiative and waiting for orders.** A supportive climate encourages autonomy and proactivity — people experiment and make things happen (the notes call this an enabling culture). In a weak climate, employees wait to be told. They will not suggest a better method. The organisation becomes slow and over-dependent on a few bosses. In a changing market this delay is a direct performance loss: competitors move, this firm waits for permission.
- 3. Training does not transfer into job behaviour.** Even if the firm spends money on courses, a weak climate kills transfer. The employee returns from training and is told ‘we don’t do it that way here’ or is overloaded so that there is no time to practise. Behaviour on the job does not change. Performance stays the same; the training budget is wasted. Analysis: climate is the soil; training is the seed. Dead soil, no crop.
- 4. Defensive, political behaviour around appraisal.** In a weak climate, ratings are used as weapons. People manage impressions, hide information, and blame other departments. Honest feedback disappears. Individuals cannot improve because they never hear the truth, or they reject the truth because they do not trust the giver. Average organisational performance is then mis-measured: files look complete, actual work is poor.
- 5. Collapse of collaboration.** HRD climate includes teamwork and help across units. When climate is weak, departments protect their boundaries. Production blames maintenance; sales blames production. Customers see delay and contradiction. Organisational performance is a system result; silo behaviour breaks the system.
- 6. Demotivation, inner resignation, absence and exit.** Higher-order needs (growth, recognition, pride) are blocked. Some people do the minimum (inner resignation). Some stay absent. The more marketable people leave. Those who remain may be those who cannot easily go. Human capital quality declines. Replacement costs, lost knowledge and weaker service all hit performance numbers.
- 7. Potential remains unused.** A core HRD idea is that human potential is relatively unlimited but must be identified and nurtured. Weak climate means nobody admits talent, nobody sponsors juniors, knowledge is hoarded so that the senior cannot be replaced. The firm pays salaries for unused capability. Growth plans fail because internally nobody is ready — a hard performance constraint.
- 8. Combined picture of organisational performance.** Put the behaviours together: more errors, less innovation, weak service, slow decisions, high attrition cost, failed strategy implementation. A student should write one

linking sentence: weak HRD climate → fearful and uncooperative behaviour → lower quality, speed, learning and human capital → weaker organisational performance. Fixing only targets or only training, without climate, will not reverse this chain.

Conclusion. *A weak HRD climate changes behaviour toward fear, silence, politics, low initiative and withdrawal. Those behaviours damage quality, customer outcomes, innovation, cost and strategy. Therefore climate is a performance variable. In the exam, write the chain with examples, not a list of adjectives like ‘bad morale’.*